KETTLE COUNTRY DISTRICT
Session 9 – Cultural Renewal – Build the Culture



CULTURAL RENEWAL ASSESSMENT

A diagnostic guide for leaders to intentionally examine unit traditions, separate core mission from routine, and align practices with today's youth and families.

Purpose
To help unit leadership step back from autopilot, recognize why traditions and routines can blur together, and intentionally choose what to **Preserve**, what to **Improve**, and what to **Renew**.

Quick Start Guide
When you sit down with your Key 3 or unit committee to run this assessment, remember the core human truth we discussed: **Every change feels equally disruptive.**

When we look at our unit's history, all our traditions, routines, and systems are tangled together. Altering a 30-year-old campout tradition can feel just as threatening to an established volunteer as changing how you collect annual dues. That is why we resist change.

The goal of this assessment is not to grade your past or make anyone feel defensive. It is to take a deep breath together and use three distinct lenses so you can steward your unit with confidence rather than fear:

1. **PRESERVE (The Anchors)**

   What it is: The bedrock elements of your unit that carry your core values, your commitment to the Scout Oath and Law, and the fundamental mission of Scouting.

   The Question to Ask: *What defines who we are at our best, and what must we fiercely protect across leadership generations?*

   Example: The solemnity of our crossover ceremonies, our commitment to youth-led troop leadership, or our standard of welcoming every new family by name.

2. **IMPROVE (The Mechanisms)**

   What it is: The operational systems that already work well, but can be made sharper, smoother, and less exhausting for your current volunteers.

   The Question to Ask: *What are we already doing right that just needs better communication, clearer checklists, or wider shared ownership?*

   Example: How you track advancement records, how you send out monthly parent emails, or how you prep for committee meetings.

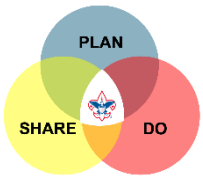
3. **RENEW (The Purpose Check)**
   What it is: Practices, traditions, or administrative habits that have survived purely on autopilot—where the activity remains, but the original purpose has quietly drifted away.

   The Question to Ask: *If we were starting this unit today from scratch, would we keep doing it this way? Does this specific tradition still serve today's youth and families?*

   Example: A legacy fundraiser that consumes three months of volunteer energy for very little return, or an overly complicated meeting format that leaves modern, busy parents confused and disconnected.

Kettle Country District

Cultural Unit Assessment



Your Committee Action Step This Week

1. **Gather the Key 3:** Set aside 30 minutes at your next committee meeting.
2. **Pick One of Each:** Look across your unit's calander and operations to identify:

   One tradition worth fiercely preserving.

   _____

   One operational practice worth improving.

   _____

   One routine or tradition that has lost its purpose and needs honest renewal or redesign.

   _____

3. **Take Action Now:** Don't wait for next year's recharter. Take one concrete step this month to honor your anchors, sharpen your mechanisms, and realign your culture with the youth you serve.

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